TOPIC 1 · 15 MIN · GMAIL · DRIVE

Lab 1: Gmail: Hand Spark Your Inbox, Then Tell It No

> Five emails are waiting. Spark reads them before you do, and you practise refusing it.

Your goal

Connect Google Workspace, run a read-only inbox task, and watch a denied action stop dead (LO1).

The story so far

Monday morning at Northstar Studio. A bakery wants a call, a motor shop wants a price you must not give, and a yoga studio is unhappy. Before Spark touches any of it, you decide what it may read and what stays with you.

You will deliver

- ☐ A task thread showing the plan and the brief
- ☐ One denied send
- ☐ One Gmail draft, unsent

Before you start

A personal Google Account on Google AI Pro or Ultra, age 18+, Keep Activity and Personal Intelligence on. A laptop with Chrome. Copy every prompt from labs/prompts.html, or from the course prompts page: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2026064173-AI-Agents-with-Gemini-Spark/labs/prompts.html

Your mock data

File in data/	What it is
northstar-content-inventory.csv	Approved and prohibited claims. Spark may only use these.
seed-emails.txt	Five made-up emails Spark drafts to you.
northstar-brand-guide.docx	Voice, colours and what the studio never says.
assets/northstar-logo.png	Fictional logo.

Steps

Step 1. Clear the gates and connect Workspace (3 min)

Where: gemini.google.com

Sign in with your personal Google Account on an AI Pro or Ultra plan. Confirm Task appears below the text box. Open Settings, search for Connected Apps and turn on Google Workspace. Leave third-party apps off. Turning on Personal Intelligence can switch off earlier connections, so re-check here. In Drive, create the folder Gemini Spark Workspace/Northstar and upload this lab's data folder.

Expect: Task is visible and Google Workspace shows as connected. No Task button? Check age 18+, a personal account, Keep Activity on, Personal Intelligence on, then call your trainer.

Step 2. Have Spark build your test inbox (4 min)

Where: Gemini → Task

Click Task, attach seed-emails.txt with Upload & tools, and paste the prompt. Open Gmail Drafts and send all five to yourself by hand.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Read the attached seed-emails.txt. Create five separate Gmail drafts addressed to me, one per email, with the subject and body exactly as written. Do not send anything. Tell me when the five drafts are ready.
```

Expect: Five drafts, and after you send them, five emails with [NORTHSTAR-LAB] in the subject.

You decide: Spark may draft. You press Send. That is the first rung of the ladder.

Step 3. Get your first brief, read-only (4 min)

Where: Gemini → Task, new thread

Paste the prompt. Read the plan before it runs, then click the progress chip and open the work panel.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Search only emails with [NORTHSTAR-LAB] in the subject. List who wants what, any deadline, and which email needs me first.
Do not archive, label, reply or send. Ask me before any change.
```

Expect: A plan first, then a brief flagging Sarah's complaint. Gmail is unchanged.

You decide: Whether the priority order is right. Spark does not know your clients. You do.

Step 4. Say no, then save a safe draft (4 min)

Where: Same task thread

Paste the first line, and deny when Gemini asks. Attach the inventory and paste the rest.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
Reply to the [NORTHSTAR-LAB] email from Raj Motors and send it now.

(After you deny, send this:)
Using only the approved rows in the attached inventory, save a Gmail draft replying to Raj Motors. Do not state a price. Offer the 20-minute discovery call. Under 100 words. Draft only.
```

Expect: Gemini asks before sending. After you deny, it stops and does not try another way. Then one draft, no price, nothing sent.

You decide: Deny the send. Raj asked for a price and your rules forbid stating one.

Checkpoint

Your inbox is unchanged, the denied send stopped dead, and one unsent draft holds no price.

If you finish early, or after class

- Type: Interview me about my work so you can set up my first task and skills. Google built this in.
- List every newsletter you have not opened in a month, and ask before unsubscribing.

If Spark does not behave as described

Menus move and results vary, so this lab states what to expect and not exact wording. Check the source in Google Help, tell your trainer, and record what you actually saw. No Pro or Ultra account in class? Pair with a neighbour and complete the Docs, Sheets and Sites templates by hand.

All company data in this lab (Northstar Studio, people, enquiries, reviews, numbers) is fictional and generated for training.